

Research Statement

Introduction

One of the most useful ideas in mathematics is *duality*: two kinds of information that appear different can determine one another. Just as the landscape shapes the trees that grow on it, the trees can also reveal the landscape beneath them. In algebraic topology, homology and cohomology provide two such perspectives on a space. My research studies how this principle appears in stable homotopy theory and arithmetic. The central goal of my research program is to understand duality and descent in *Real algebraic K-theory*, particularly how global information can be recovered from local data while retaining symmetry. My dissertation establishes a first step through a *K-theoretic duality theorem* for number fields. My current work extends this question to *Grothendieck–Witt theory* and develops *Real trace methods* for computation, while my work in equivariant algebra provides a foundation for organizing the symmetries and operations that arise in this broader program.

1 Background

Topology often turns geometric questions about spaces into algebraic ones. Homology studies geometric features inside a space, such as connected pieces, loops, and higher-dimensional holes. Cohomology begins from a different point of view: it studies algebraic data that behave like functions living on the space and how such data fit together globally. The *Universal Coefficient Theorem* explains that these two kinds of information are closely related. For example, with coefficients in a field k , this relationship takes the particularly simple form

$$H^n(X; k) \cong \text{Hom}_k(H_n(X; k), k),$$

The power of duality allows a problem expressed in one kind of information to be understood through a seemingly different kind.

The spaces and algebraic objects studied in topology often carry symmetries, which provide another important source of structure. For example, a circle can be reflected across an axis or rotated by half a turn. Reflection fixes two points, while the half-turn fixes none. Once the symmetries are forgotten, the underlying space is the same circle in both cases. Equivariant topology retains this information by studying not only the space itself, but also how its symmetries act and what remains fixed.

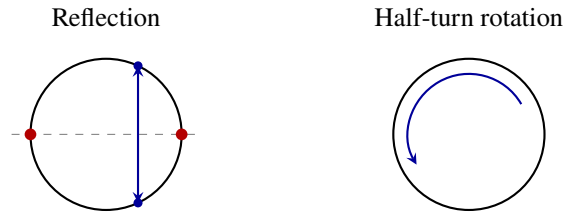


Figure 1: Two symmetries of the same underlying circle. Reflection fixes two red points, while rotation by half a turn fixes none.

K-theory is a central setting in which both duality and equivariant phenomena arise. Topological K-theory studies vector bundles over spaces, while algebraic K-theory studies their algebraic counterparts, such as projective modules over rings. When the spaces, bundles, or rings under study carry symmetries, K-theory can be refined to retain them. Atiyah introduced Real K-theory to study complex vector bundles together with symmetry modeled on complex conjugation. Real algebraic K-theory is an algebraic variant of Atiyah's theory for rings with involution. It therefore provides a setting in which duality in algebraic K-theory can be studied while retaining symmetry.

2 Arithmetic Duality and Algebraic K-theory

2.1 K-theoretic Tate–Poitou duality. In arithmetic, Tate–Poitou duality relates étale cohomology groups for number fields in complementary degrees. My dissertation asks whether this arithmetic duality also appears in stable homotopy theory.

Algebraic K-theory contains rich arithmetic information, but it is notoriously difficult to compute. Its $K(1)$ -local variant provides a more accessible approximation. The Quillen–Lichtenbaum conjecture shows that this is a good approximation to algebraic K-theory, while the Thomason spectral sequence connects it to étale cohomology [Tho85, RW00, Mit00]. This suggests that arithmetic duality should have a corresponding form in stable homotopy theory.

Calegari conjectured that this duality holds at the level of homotopy groups [CE12]. Blumberg and Mandell proved a stronger spectrum-level duality at every odd prime using Anderson duality, a spectral refinement of Pontrjagin duality for abelian groups [BM20]. The prime 2 remained open because real embeddings produce cohomological behavior that does not occur at odd primes. My dissertation completes the result at this remaining prime.

Theorem 1 ([Cho25]). *Let F be a number field. There is a canonical weak equivalence*

$$\mathrm{Fib}(\kappa_F) \simeq \Sigma^{-1} I_{\mathbb{Z}_2} L_{K(1)} K(\mathcal{O}_F[\tfrac{1}{2}]),$$

where

$$\kappa_F: L_{K(1)} K(\mathcal{O}_F[\tfrac{1}{2}]) \longrightarrow \prod_{\nu|2} L_{K(1)} K(F_\nu)$$

is the completion map.

The theorem gives a homotopical refinement of Tate–Poitou duality and it recovers the classical Tate–Poitou exact sequence on homotopy groups.

The following Figure summarizes the passage from arithmetic duality to its homotopical refinement.

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \textbf{Arithmetic duality:} & H_{\text{ét}}^s(\mathcal{O}_F[\tfrac{1}{p}]; \mathbb{Z}/p^k(\tfrac{t}{2})) & \xleftarrow{\text{Pontryagin dual}} H_c^{3-s}(\mathcal{O}_F[\tfrac{1}{p}]; \mathbb{Z}/p^k(-\tfrac{t}{2})) \\
 \downarrow \text{Thomason SS} & \Downarrow & \Downarrow \\
 \textbf{Homotopical duality:} & L_{K(1)} K(\mathcal{O}_F[\tfrac{1}{p}]) & \xleftarrow{\text{Anderson dual}} \mathrm{Fib}(\kappa)
 \end{array}$$

Figure 2: Arithmetic and homotopical dualities in parallel, linked by the Thomason descent spectral sequence.

The case $F = \mathbb{Q}$ also has an application to the algebraic K-theory of the sphere spectrum. Combining the duality theorem with known comparison results gives a canonical equivalence in nonnegative degrees

$$\Sigma^{-1} I_{\mathbb{Z}_2} L_{K(1)} K(\mathbb{Z}) \underset{[0, \infty)}{\simeq} \mathrm{Fib}(\mathrm{trcs} : K(\mathbb{S})_2^\wedge \longrightarrow TC(\mathbb{S})_2^\wedge). \quad (1)$$

Thus arithmetic information contained in the K-theory of the integers determines the error in a fundamental approximation to the algebraic K-theory of the sphere.

More broadly, this result provides a nonequivariant starting point for my study of duality in Real algebraic K-theory. It suggests that K-theoretic Tate–Poitou duality may be one shadow of a larger picture in which duality is compatible with involutions and C_2 -symmetry. My next projects approach this broader question through Grothendieck–Witt theory and Real trace methods.

2.2 Grothendieck–Witt theory and Real duality. K-theory가 proj module에 대한 이야기라면, GW는 module with bilinear form에 대한 이야기입니다. 또한 real vector bundle에 대응하는 algebraic analogue라고 볼수도 있습니다. ring에 involution이 있는 경우에, K-theory는 그 symmetry를 inherit하며, C2 fixed point가 바로 GW theory입니다. 매우 중요함; algebraic L-theory과도 연관이 있고.. etc.

F 가 local field인 경우에, K(1)-local GW 의 Anderson dual은 form twist를 2만큼 shift시킨다는게 conjecture.

2.3 Homological Real trace methods. While duality describes structural relationships in Real algebraic K-theory, explicit calculations usually require a different set of tools. In joint work with Teena Gerhardt, Liam Keenan, Juan C. Moreno, and J.D. Quigley, I develop *homological Real trace methods* for computing Real trace invariants [CGK⁺26]. Real trace methods approach KR through more computable invariants built from Real topological Hochschild homology THR . The natural $O(2)$ -action on THR gives rise to more refined trace invariants, including TCR and TCR^- .

Our main tool is a spectral sequence that uses the homology of THR to compute the continuous homology of TCR^- , while retaining multiplicative structure and equivariant power operations. As first applications, we carry out these computations for Real bordism $MU_{\mathbb{R}}$, Real Brown–Peterson theory $BP_{\mathbb{R}}$, and several truncated variants of $BP_{\mathbb{R}}$, which form a fundamental family of examples in equivariant chromatic homotopy theory.

Theorem 2 ([CGK⁺26]). *For a C_2 -equivariant commutative ring spectrum A , there is a natural multiplicative spectral sequence*

$$H_{\star}(THR(A); \mathbb{F}_2) \langle \bar{y} \rangle \implies H_{\star}^c(TCR^-(A); \mathbb{F}_2),$$

compatible with equivariant power operations. For $MU_{\mathbb{R}}$, $BP_{\mathbb{R}}$, and several truncated Brown–Peterson theories, we determine the differentials and the E_{∞} -page of the resulting spectral sequences.

Our construction is a Real refinement of the homological trace methods developed by Bruner and Rognes [BR05]. In the nonequivariant setting, their methods became an important tool in the study of Segal conjectures for topological Hochschild homology of MU and BP . Guided by this precedent, my long-term goal is to use homological Real trace methods to formulate and study a Real analogue of the Segal conjecture, beginning with the trace invariants of $MU_{\mathbb{R}}$ and $BP_{\mathbb{R}}$. This would extend the present calculations toward a broader understanding of TCR and Real algebraic K-theory.

Our computations use the multiplicative and power-operation structure carried by the homology of THR . This makes the algebra of genuine equivariant operations an essential input to Real trace methods. It leads to the broader question of which collections of equivariant operations can occur together. My work discussed next studies the algebraic and homotopical foundations of this question.

3 Current research and direction

Building on the framework of stable homotopy theory, my current research explores how algebraic and homotopical ideas interact across several fronts, particularly through *algebraic K-theory*, *equivariant algebra*, and their connections to number theory and combinatorics. Rather than treating these areas in isolation, I study how organizing principles such as duality, symmetry, and operadic compatibility arise in parallel forms across them. The following sections describe how these themes manifest in my recent and ongoing work.

3.1 Equivariant algebras and homotopical combinatorics. My research in equivariant algebras investigates how combinatorial structures capture and control operations arising in *equivariant stable homotopy theory*. A central organizing idea is the notion of a *transfer system* [Rub21], which encodes which “transfer” maps between subgroups are allowed, subject to natural coherence conditions such as compatibility with conjugation and restriction. For example, in the case of the cyclic group C_{p^2} , the possible transfer systems are shown in Figure 3.

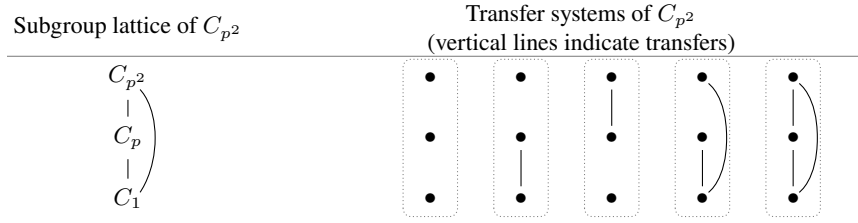


Figure 3: Subgroup lattice of the cyclic group C_{p^2} of order p^2 (left) and its five distinct transfer systems (right). These five systems classify, up to homotopy, the N_∞ -operads for C_{p^2} .

Transfer systems provide a combinatorial model for the algebraic structure underlying genuine equivariant commutative ring spectra, encoded by *Tambara functors* [Tam93]. Their additive (transfer) and multiplicative (norm) operations are governed by a pair of transfer systems satisfying a compatibility condition, forming a *compatible pair*. In collaboration with David Chan, David Mehrle, Pablo Sanchez Ocal, Angelica Osorno, Ben Szczesny, and Paula Verdugo, we study the correspondence between such combinatorial data and the *pairings of N_∞ -operads* [May09] that model these operations. Constructing an operad pairing is subtle even non-equivariantly, and our results give the first systematic framework for realizing them in the genuine equivariant setting through explicit combinatorial data.

Theorem 3 ([CCM⁺25]). *If two N_∞ -operads admit a pairing, then their associated transfer systems form a compatible pair. If a compatible pair of transfer systems has a complete additive component, then there exists a pairing of N_∞ -operads that realizes it.*

Motivated by this result, we conjecture that the correspondence between compatible pairs and operadic pairings holds in full generality:

Conjecture. *For every finite group G , every compatible pair of G -transfer systems should be realizable by some pairing of N_∞ -operads.*

Establishing this equivalence would complete the conceptual bridge between the combinatorial and homotopical descriptions of incomplete Tambara functors and provide a combinatorial classification of admissible equivariant multiplicative structures.

Building on this framework, we have proved several further realizability results that support this conjecture. For instance, the transfer systems associated to the equivariant linear isometries and Steiner operads are realized by the corresponding pairing of operads, and J -local transfer systems $(\mathcal{T}_J, \mathcal{T}_J)$ are likewise

realizable for any subgroup $J \leq G$. Moreover, we introduce a general construction principle showing that whenever two *intersection monoids* M and N admit a pairing $\xi: M \times N \rightarrow N$, one obtains a corresponding pairing of operads $(\mathcal{O}^\vee(M), \mathcal{O}^\vee(N))$.

Together, these results form the first systematic framework for classifying compatible transfer system pairs and understanding how combinatorial and homotopical perspectives on equivariant algebra align. They provide a computable foundation for studying incomplete Tambara functors and genuine equivariant ring spectra, and illustrate how ideas from combinatorics and operad theory drive new advances in equivariant homotopy theory.

3.2 Real algebraic K-theory and homological trace methods. *Real algebraic K-theory* offers a framework for studying algebraic structures equipped with involutive symmetries, combining topological and arithmetic ideas. Introduced by Hesselholt and Madsen [HM13], it assigns genuine C_2 -equivariant spectra to rings with an *anti-involution*. This theory refines and unifies classical algebraic K-theory, Hermitian K-theory, and L -theory by incorporating this additional symmetry.

In collaboration with Teena Gerhardt, Liam Keenan, Juan Moreno, and J.D. Quigley, we are extending the *homological trace methods* developed by Bruner and Rognes [BR05] to the C_2 -equivariant setting, specifically targeting *Real Topological Hochschild Homology* (THR). To manage the equivariant filtration, we define the notion of a *slice complex*, which serves as a CW complex counterpart to the slice filtration. Using this framework, we prove an analogue of the cellular approximation theorem for these complexes. This foundation allows us to construct a new spectral sequence based on $RO(C_2)$ -graded homology, providing computational access to invariants in Real algebraic K-theory.

Theorem 4 (Gerhardt–Cho–Keenan–Moreno–Quigley). *For a C_2 -equivariant E_∞ -ring spectrum R with twisted $\mathbb{T}$ -action, there is a natural $\mathcal{A}_\star^{C_2}$ -comodule algebra spectral sequence of Mackey functors:*

$$E_{*,*}^2 = H^{-*}(B_{C_2}\mathbb{T}; H\underline{\mathbb{F}}_{2*}(R)) \Rightarrow H\underline{\mathbb{F}}_{2*}^c(R^{h_{C_2}\mathbb{T}})$$

The introduction of the slice complex does more than facilitate this spectral sequence. We expect this framework to yield other CW complex properties and provide a more intuitive geometric perspective on equivariant spaces and spectra.

Our approach builds on recent advances in *Real trace methods*, which adapt topological Hochschild and cyclic homology to the C_2 -equivariant context [Dot12, Høg16]. Extending the homological approach of Bruner and Rognes to this setting yields new computational methods for studying equivariant invariants and new approximations for important spectra such as the *Real bordism spectrum* $MU_{\mathbb{R}}$.

The long-term goal of this project is to apply these techniques to analyze the Real algebraic K-theory of fundamental spectra including $MU_{\mathbb{R}}$ and the *Real Brown-Peterson spectrum* $BP_{\mathbb{R}}$. In particular, we aim to establish a *Real analogue of the Segal conjecture* for these spectra, which would parallel one of the most powerful computational results in classical topology and provide new insights into how symmetry shapes algebraic K-theory at chromatic height 1 and beyond.

4 Future research direction

My future research builds directly on my current work, extending results on duality phenomena in algebraic K-theory and advancing the foundations of equivariant algebra. A central aim is to further develop the connections between homotopical methods, arithmetic dualities, and symmetry in algebraic and geometric contexts.

In parallel, I plan to develop projects that emphasize concrete computations and examples, especially in areas such as homotopical combinatorics and topological data analysis. These topics are well suited for

undergraduate involvement and provide natural entry points into algebraic topology. I view cultivating such accessible research directions as an essential part of advancing the field and training the next generation of mathematicians.

Duality and Symmetry in Algebraic K-theory The emerging framework of *K-theoretic duality* reveals deep structural parallels between arithmetic geometry and stable homotopy theory. Its development points naturally toward several new directions, including higher-dimensional analogues, chromatic refinements, and Real equivariant formulations that extend the reach of duality across algebraic and homotopical contexts.

A natural first step is to understand how K-theoretic duality behaves in higher dimensions. While substantial progress has been made for odd primes [Bra25], the higher-dimensional case at the prime 2 remains unresolved. The techniques developed in my thesis for addressing the subtleties of the 2-adic setting provide the tools needed to approach this open case and to clarify how duality extends across arithmetic dimension.

At the same time, these arithmetic phenomena suggest parallel structures in the *chromatic* layers of stable homotopy theory. Recent results [HRW22] indicate that the connective Adams summand l exhibits arithmetic-like behavior analogous to that of local rings in number theory. This analogy points toward a chromatic form of arithmetic duality, and I aim to formulate a corresponding K-theoretic duality at higher chromatic heights.

A third direction arises in the *Real* or C_2 -equivariant context, where algebraic K-theory interacts with symmetry in a genuinely equivariant way. An ultimate goal is the construction of a *Real Thomason spectral sequence*, serving as a computational bridge between equivariant cohomology and Real algebraic K-theory. Achieving this requires developing an equivariant form of étale cohomology for commutative ring spectra and adapting descent methods to the C_2 -equivariant setting. Such a framework would parallel Thomason's classical spectral sequence while opening a systematic approach to the computation of Real algebraic K-theory.

Foundations for Equivariant Algebra A key direction of my future work is to develop the basic algebraic framework underlying equivariant stable homotopy theory. While advanced constructions such as Tambara functors capture much of the structure, many of the elementary notions familiar from commutative algebra remain to be formulated in the equivariant setting.

A natural entry point is the study of commutative G -rings, a simpler type of equivariant algebraic object that Tambara functors generalize. Even in this case, elementary concepts such as algebraic extensions and algebraic closures exhibit subtle equivariant pathologies. Investigating these questions offers an accessible entry point that also exposes conceptual obstructions in the more general theory of Tambara functors. Beginning with these manageable cases allows one to develop the algebraic intuition and categorical techniques needed to approach the full equivariant framework.

My goal is to establish such foundational concepts and structures within the equivariant setting. This foundational program would provide the analogue of commutative algebra for equivariant algebraic geometry, bridging the gap between algebraic and homotopical formulations of equivariant descent.

Undergraduate Research Directions Several aspects of my work give rise to problems and projects that are accessible at an undergraduate level yet remain closely connected to broader research questions. Two areas in particular, combinatorial transfer systems and topological data analysis (TDA), offer tractable problems that both engage students and contribute to the development of my research programs.

One direction of my work focuses on the study of *transfer systems* from a combinatorial and educational perspective. Because transfer systems are defined directly in terms of subgroup lattices, they are easy to state and visualize, making them particularly suitable for undergraduate research projects. At the same

time, their enumeration already reveals rich combinatorial structure: for example, the number of transfer systems for cyclic groups coincides with the *Catalan numbers* [BBR21], and many related patterns remain to be understood. Exploring these systems provides an accessible way to connect discrete mathematics with deeper questions in equivariant topology. Counting and classifying finite posets associated with transfer systems not only offer combinatorial insight but also inform the structural classification of N_∞ -operads and Tambara functors, clarifying how discrete data govern admissible algebraic operations. In this way, the topic serves both as an entry point for students and as a bridge between combinatorics and the homotopical study of equivariant algebra.

Another area is *topological data analysis* (TDA), which applies algebraic topology to study the structure of high-dimensional data sets. Methods such as *persistent homology* can be introduced in a visual and computationally accessible way, yet they lead naturally into deeper questions about stability, functoriality, and the role of cohomology operations. These connections remain an active area of research, and concrete case studies in TDA provide a natural testing ground for exploring how homotopical invariants can yield new insights into the shape and geometry of data.

In this way, projects in combinatorics and data science serve not only as entry points for undergraduate participation but also as stepping stones toward more advanced problems aligned with my core research agenda.

5 Conclusion

At the heart of my research lies the perspective of *stable homotopy theory*, a framework in which topology, algebra, and geometry meet on equal footing. Within this setting, ideas such as duality and equivariance reveal how seemingly distinct structures reflect the same underlying homotopical patterns. My work develops this viewpoint to clarify the shared logic that links arithmetic, combinatorics, and topology.

Looking ahead, I aim to expand this program by using stable homotopy theory to understand duality and symmetry across mathematical contexts. A central goal is to build conceptual and computational tools in algebraic K-theory and equivariant homotopy theory that clarify how these structures behave and interact. I also consider it essential to keep this research program accessible by identifying problems suitable for undergraduate projects and fostering collaboration at various levels of expertise.

Ultimately, my research advances both the technical reach of stable homotopy theory and its practical role as a common ground where diverse mathematical ideas can interact.

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